

One of Europe's
most brilliant
periods

THE AGE OF THE Baroque

1610-1660

By **CARL J. FRIEDRICH**,
Harvard University

THE violence, color and en-
during achievements of a
tumultuous epoch are here
recorded in dramatic style by
Carl J. Friedrich, who shows
how "the baroque state of
mind" molded such great and
diverse figures as Richelieu
and Cromwell, Descartes and
Galileo, Reubens and Velas-
quez.

A new volume in *The Rise of Modern
Europe*, with an introduction by Wil-
liam L. Langer. 32 pages of halftones;
endpapers. \$5.00

At all bookstores

HARPER

What do you know about

YOU?

UNDERSTANDING HEREDITY

By **RICHARD B. GOLDSCHMIDT**

There's amazing knowledge in this
compact genetics "primer."

Why you are what you are... why
you are different from others...
genetic sense and nonsense... and
a great deal more.

A fascinating volume, written by
one of the world's foremost geneti-
cists in a way that anyone can un-
derstand and enjoy. 1952 \$3.75

At your bookstore or direct from
JOHN WILEY & SONS, INC.
440 Fourth Ave., New York 16, N. Y.

THE INCREDIBLE ITALIANS

(Continued from page 12)

action against him and his rhetoric.

Around the time of the First World War an attempt at obtaining inter-
national importance, even using some
of the modern methods of propaganda
(manifestos, speeches), had been
made by F. T. Marinetti with his
movement called "futurism," a noisy
affair intended to influence not only
literature (e.g., with an idea of poems
as *parole in libertà*, "words at liberty,"
and other such harmless, mildly offen-
sive, and hence catchy bywords: "Let's
kill the moonlight... The gondola is
the rocking-chair of cretins," he would
say for instance in public speeches to
the Venetians), but also art styles in
general and even manners and feel-
ings. The movement had no lasting lit-
erary importance or influence. Marin-
etti's strategies are indicative in con-
nection with some of our earlier re-
marks: to launch his movement he
went to Paris; his first manifestos, in
French, were published in a Parisian
newspaper (he was bilingual).

After the First World War a less
noisy but literarily more significant
attempt at capturing international au-
diences was made by Massimo Bon-

tempelli with his review entitled 900.
During its first years, it was published
in French. Such writers as Corrado
Alvaro and Alberto Moravia published
their first stories there in the late
Twenties. Again a tag was possible,
the notion of a movement called "900"
(standing in Italian for "twentieth
century"), though entirely indefinite
in its nature, was often repeated as a
kind of formula.

A SLOGAN that never caught on, as
far as serious literature is con-
cerned, is the "Fascist" slogan; a Fas-
cist literature in Italy to all practical
purposes did not exist. To some this
may seem a pity, for a shelf of tales
about Fascist hierarchs and warriors
drawn to heroic scale, or a collection of
odes celebrating the dictator could have
had some interest as period-pieces or
literary monstrosities. The world ex-
pected a critical, rebellious, or satiric
literature reflecting life under Fas-
cism; for obvious reasons this could
not openly come out of Italy as long
as the totalitarian regime lasted. Nor
did foreign audiences possess sufficient
interest and linguistic equipment to ap-

Your Literary I.Q.

By Howard Collins

LITERARY MONEY

Dr. Dan Laurence, of New York University, asks you to identify the following
literary figures whose lives were affected by money, and also the works in which
they appear. Allowing five points for each correct answer, a score of sixty is
par, seventy is very good, and eighty or better is excellent. Answers on page 37.

1. A good-natured young man gives his last two guineas to a highwayman upon discovering that he has been driven to crime by direst poverty.
2. A woman wheedles money from her husband to pay a debt of which he has no knowledge but which was responsible for saving his life.
3. A powerful magnate tells his estranged daughter that his religion is being a millionaire.
4. An old man is forced by his son to choose between the woman they both love and the fortune which has been stolen from him.
5. An army officer causes the death of an old woman and her ward when he attempts to discover a secret formula for gambling success.
6. A successful paint manufacturer goes bankrupt in preference to permitting an unscrupulous partner to involve him in a dishonest business deal.
7. A young lady receives an unexpected inheritance from an uncle whose son has requested the bequest so that she may be free to follow her natural bent.
8. A wealthy man, endowed with every grace and the envy of all the townsfolk, goes home and ends his life.
9. A misanthropic old man hoards his money for fifteen years, only to have it stolen by the son of the town's most influential citizen.
10. A businessman is haled into court to pay a fatal forfeit for having failed to make good on a usurer's loan.